ARA Ansible for the teams

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DevConf.us, Boston, MA 02446, USA, 19-20 September 2025
*presenting personal opinion

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Who this talk is for?

You know what Ansible is

You use Ansible

You create Ansible content - collections, roles, plugins, modules

You would like to know **what ARA Ansible is and how to use** it personally and with your colleagues

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What is ARA Ansible?



https://ara.recordsansible.org/

ARA = **A**RA **R**ecords **A**nsible

ARA is a tool that Records Ansible playbook executions and makes it easier to understand and troubleshoot Ansible content

All in user friendly Web interface

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Why ARA Ansible?

You **do not need** to look at ill formatted console output

You **do not need** to have debug tasks in your Ansible playbooks, roles and task files

Everything is **persisted**, easily searchable and shareable.

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How can you benefit from ARA Ansible right now? Install ARA as container

```
% mkdir -p ~/.ara/server
% podman run --name ara --detach --tty \
  --volume ~/.ara/server:/opt/ara -p 8000:8000 \
   docker.io/recordsansible/ara-api:latest
```

Google *“ara ansible docker”*

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How can you benefit from ARA Ansible right now? Use ARA from any playbook

```
% python3 -m pip install --user ara
```

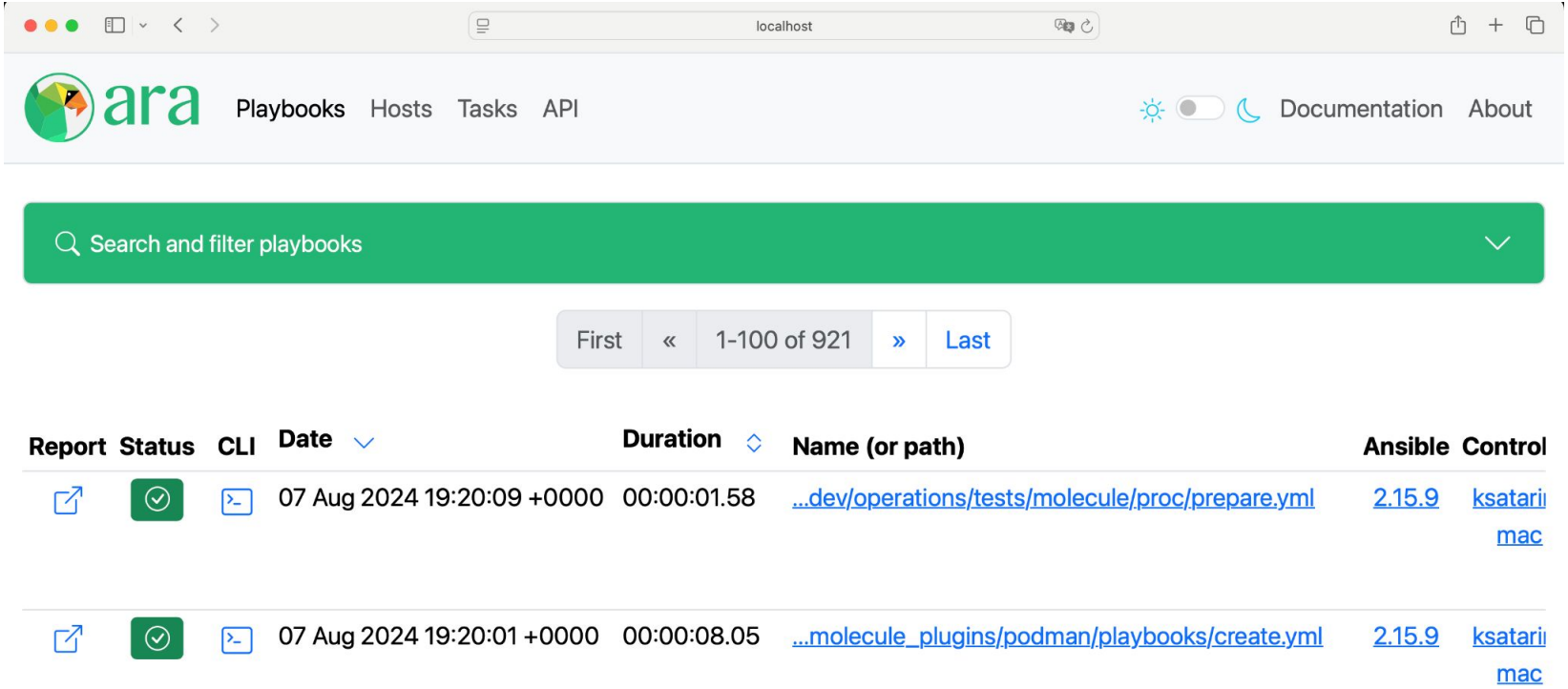
add to .bashrc, .zshrc, etc and dot forget to source

```
export ANSIBLE_CALLBACK_PLUGINS="$(python3 -m
ara.setup.callback_plugins)"
export ARA_API_CLIENT="http"
export ARA_API_SERVER="http://localhost:8000"

% ansible-playbook playbook.yml
```

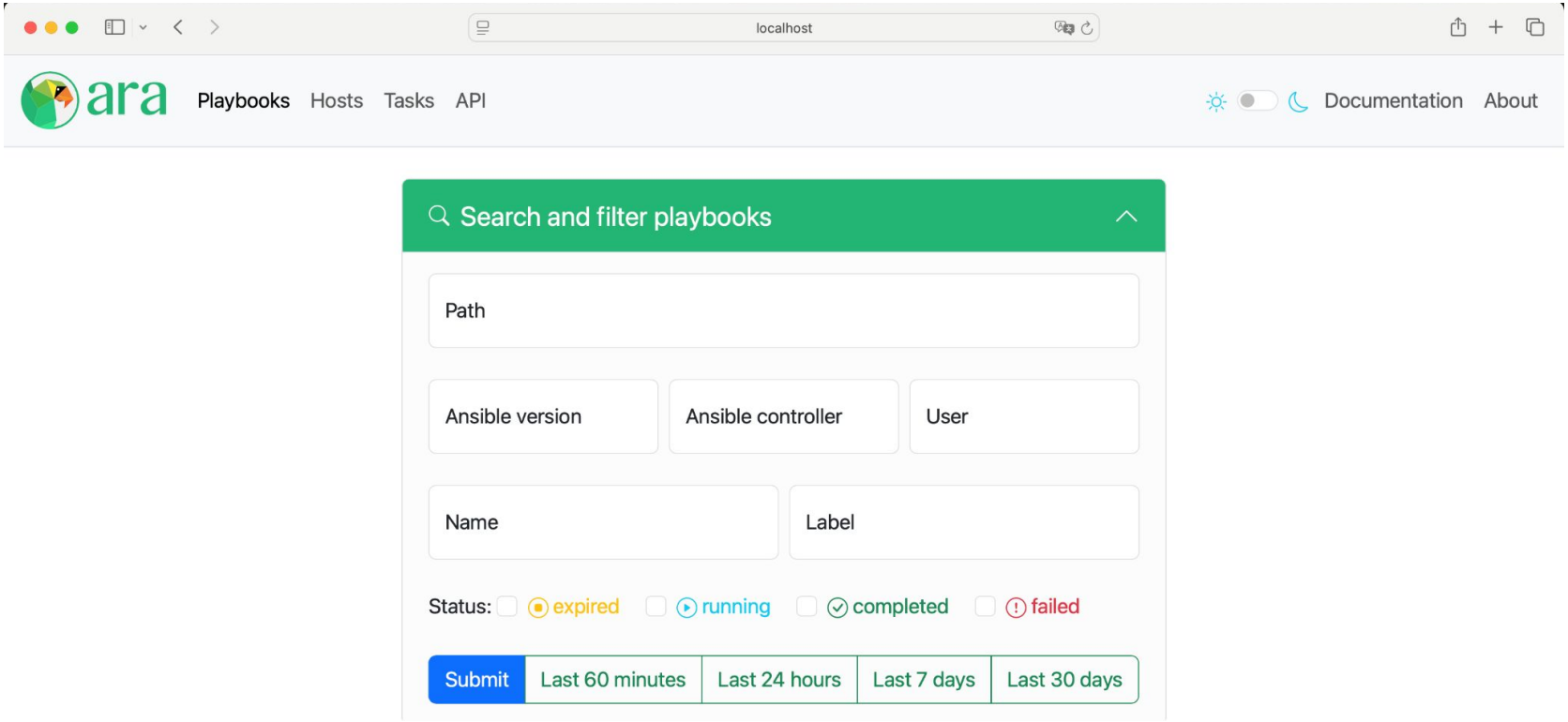
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ARA in Action: Playbooks



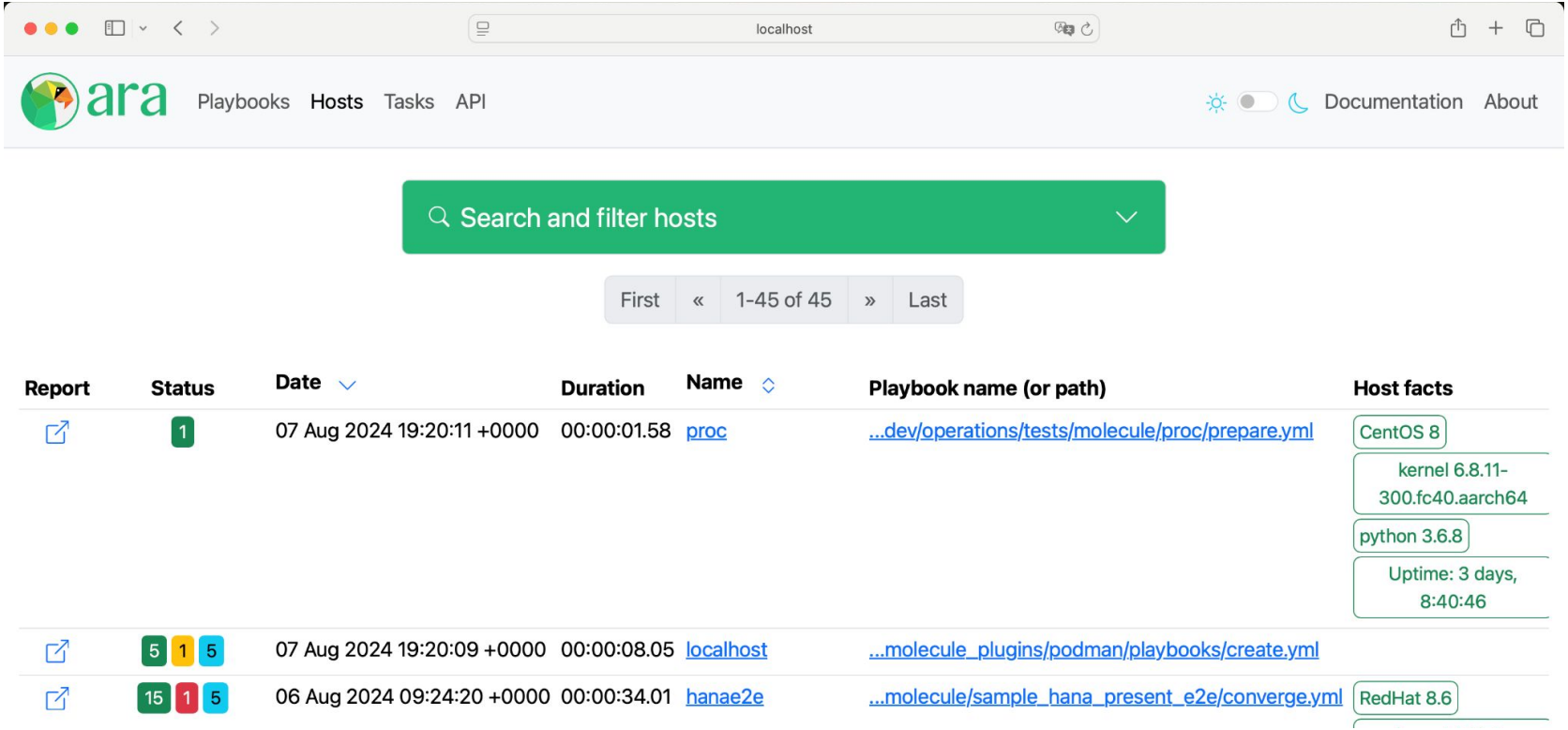
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ARA in Action: Playbooks filter



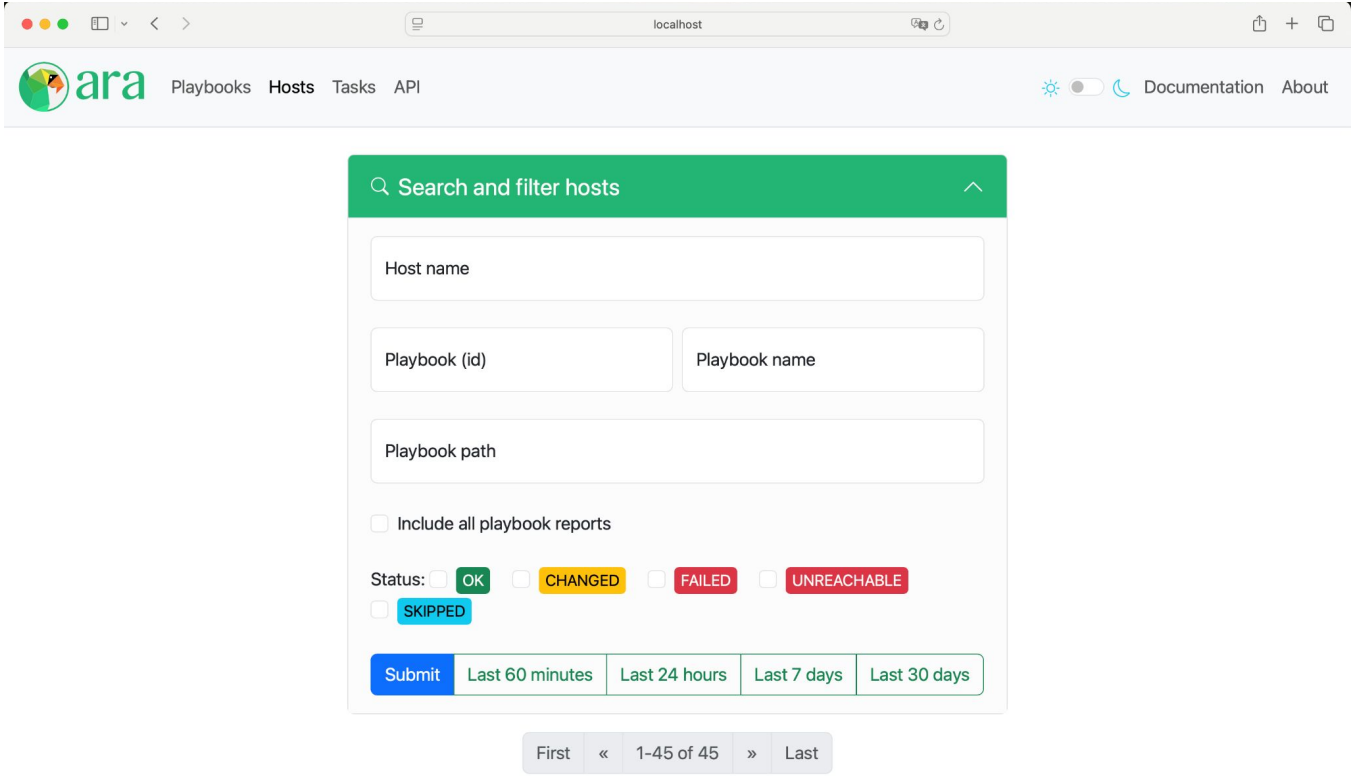
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ARA in Action: Hosts



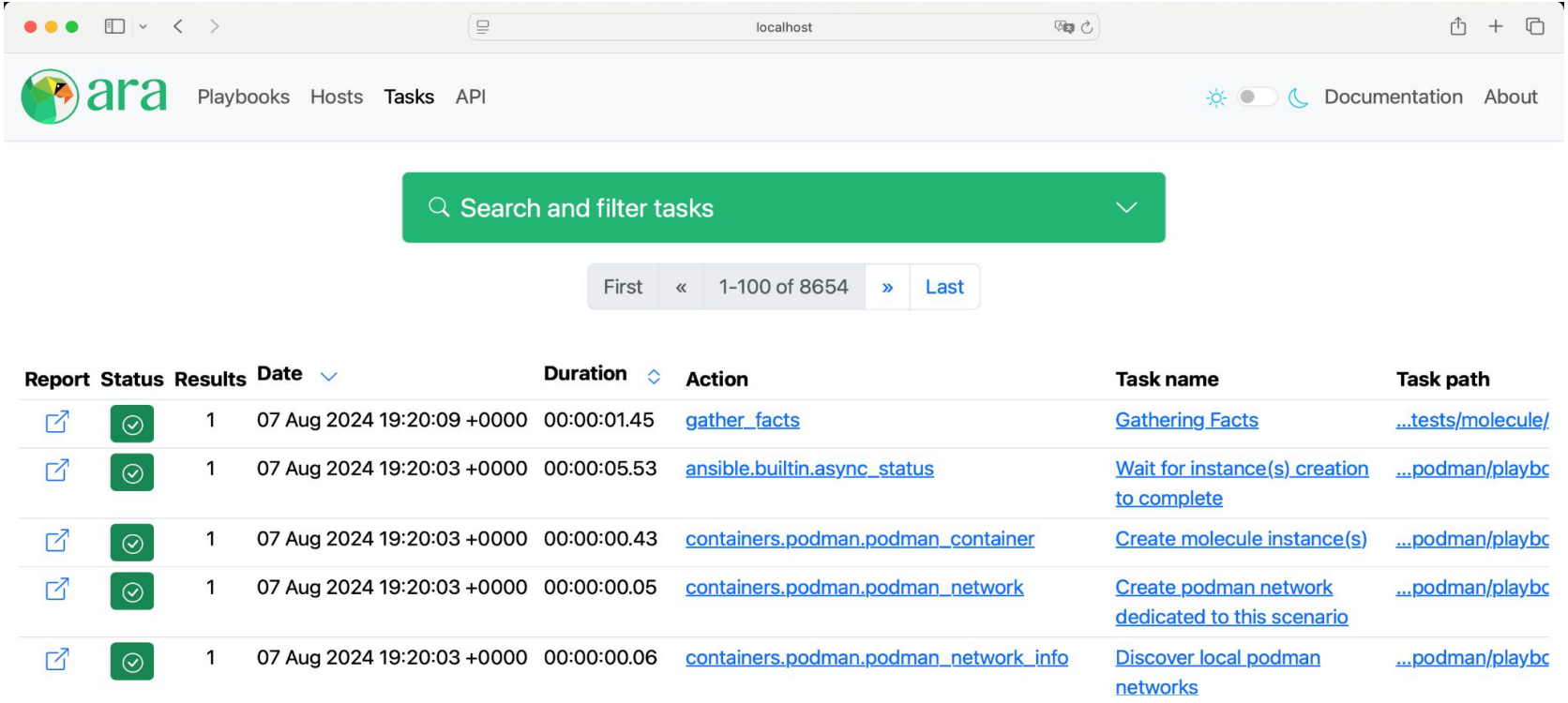
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ARA in Action: Hosts Filter



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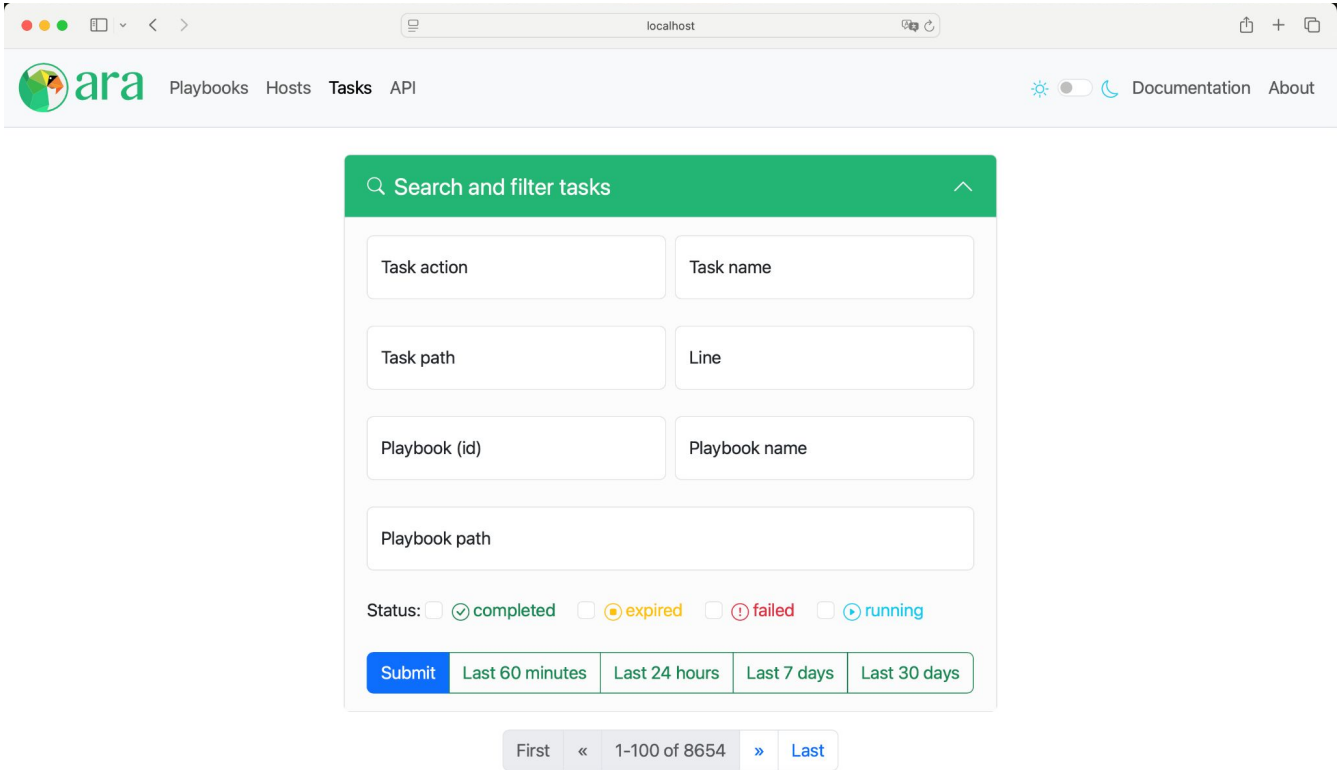
ARA in Action: Tasks



Report	Status	Results	Date	Duration	Action	Task name	Task path
		1	07 Aug 2024 19:20:09 +0000	00:00:01.45	gather_facts	Gathering Facts	...tests/molecule/
		1	07 Aug 2024 19:20:03 +0000	00:00:05.53	ansible.builtin.async_status	Wait for instance(s) creation to complete	...podman/playbc
		1	07 Aug 2024 19:20:03 +0000	00:00:00.43	containers.podman.podman_container	Create molecule instance(s)	...podman/playbc
		1	07 Aug 2024 19:20:03 +0000	00:00:00.05	containers.podman.podman_network	Create podman network dedicated to this scenario	...podman/playbc
		1	07 Aug 2024 19:20:03 +0000	00:00:00.06	containers.podman.podman_network_info	Discover local podman networks	...podman/playbc

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ARA in Action: Tasks Filter



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ARA persists following data (summary)

All playbooks executed, in reverse chronological order filtered by:

Path, ansible version, controller hostname,executed user, playbook name, label

All hosts with number of tasks - successful, changed, failed, skipped.

Filtered by: hostname, playbook name and path

All executed tasks filtered by name, action, path, line, playbook name and path.

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ARA how to use what is stored

Forward all playbook executions to ARA - you never know when you will need it, and you do not need any *debug* tasks anymore.

Compare with any playbook execution from **the past** - something broke - you will know what changed

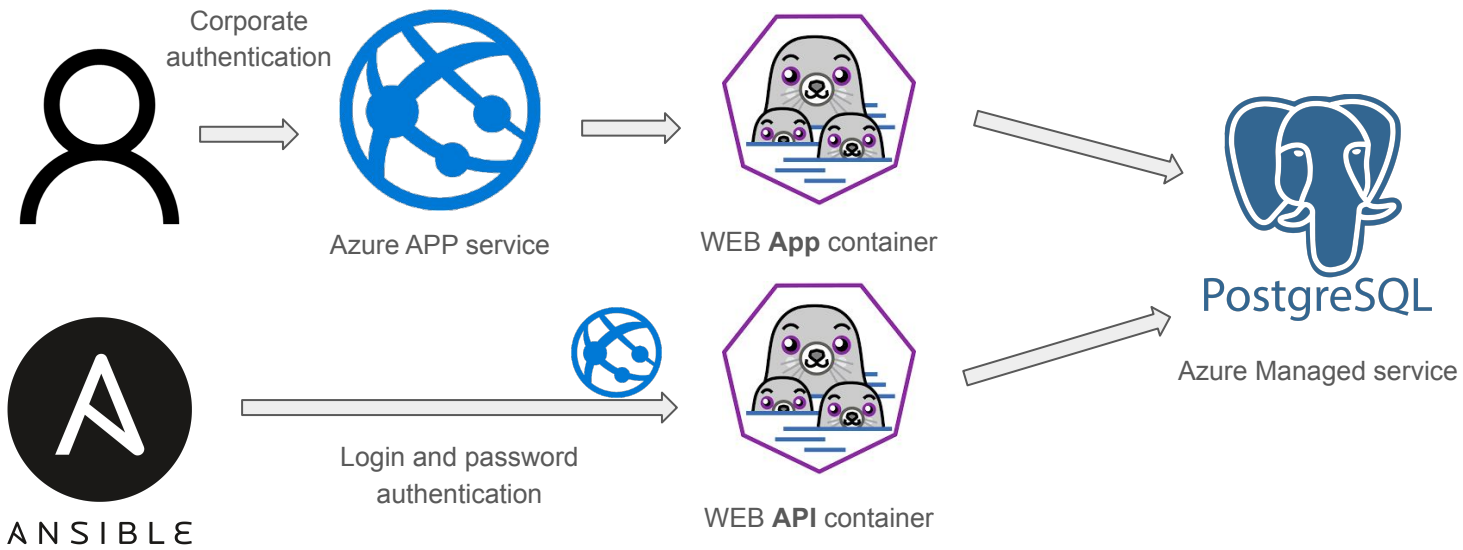
Each and every execution has unique URL - share it in your issues, PRs, slack, documentation.

How to do that? **Install ARA “globally”!**

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Install ARA “globally”

- Use whatever way you prefer, example here is for Azure



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ARA for the teams - monthly cost example (Azure)

Database

Service	Service family	Provider	Publisher type	Total ↓
Azure Data... ···	Databases	Azure	Microsoft	$16.99

Tier	Total ↓
Azure Database for PostgreSQL Flexible Server Burstable BS Series Compute	$8.83
Az DB for PostgreSQL Flexible Server Storage	$8.16

This is the smallest PostgreSQL database - plenty for ARA:

32GB storage, lowest performance tier (120 iops)

Backup policy - 7 days in the past - daily.

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ARA for the teams - monthly cost example (Azure)

Application

Service	Service family	Provider	Total ↓
> Azure App Service ···	Compute	Azure	$70.31

Both containers use shared 1 vCPU and 4 GB RAM

Memory utilization 60% - stable

CPU utilization 10 % with peaks to 50%

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ARA for the teams - CONS

Additional time for http requests to ARA server - make sure it is it the right region / location

If you have playbooks with many tasks expect longer execution time

Cost - someone will have to pay for the server (we pay around 60 USD / month)

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ARA for the teams - summary

ARA is a tool that **every Ansible practitioner should use**

Use ARA locally - only two steps - **takes less than 5 minutes***

*depends on your internet connection

Use ARA “globally” **to achieve more with your team and colleagues** - some planning and effort is required, cost is negligible

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